## MADHYA PRADESH

*At the core of the Congress manifesto are nine rights—to water, health, electricity, education, food, housing, minimum income, employment and social security*

- **Women's welfare:** The Nari Samman scheme is a counter to the BJP government's Ladli Bahna Yojana; promises Rs 1,500 per month to every woman, Rs 500 for LPG cylinder
- **Vardan:** Taking a cue from the Rajasthan govt, this insurance scheme promises Rs 25 lakh health cover, Rs 10 lakh accident cover to all families
- **Farmers:** Rs 2,500/ 2,600 per quintal MSP for paddy/ wheat farmers on lines of the Baghel government's flagship scheme in Chhattisgarh
- **Social security:** Revival of the Old Pension Scheme, as already done in many Opposition-ruled states
- **Jobs:** Filling up over 200,000 government vacancies, creating 100,000 new jobs in villages

## TELANGANA

*On Sept. 17, Sonia Gandhi announced six guarantees for Telangana, modelled on the party's promises in Karnataka*

- **Mahalakshmi:** Rs 2,500 per month to women, free travel in buses, cooking gas cylinders at Rs 500
- **Gruhajyothy:** 200 units of free power to all poor households
- **Indiramma Rythu Bharosa:** Farmers to get Rs 15,000 and farmhands Rs 12,000 per year
- **Cheyutha:** Rs 10 lakh insurance cover for the poor; Rs 4,000 monthly pension for the elderly, widows, etc.
- **Indiramma Indlu:** Plot of land and Rs 5 lakh for homeless/ landless families
- **Yuva Vikasam:** BPL students to get Rs 5 lakh assistance to pursue higher education

## BROKEN PROMISES

- **Unemployment allowance:** All jobless youths were to get Rs 3,016 per month
- **Reservations:** Change in caste categories to extend reservations; 12 per cent quota in education and employment was promised to Muslims too
- **2BHK Housing:** Only 160,000 applications of the 360,000 shortlisted beneficiaries verified; just 75,000 homes handed over
- **Dalit Bandhu:** Only 40,000, or 2.4 per cent, of the 1.7 million eligible ST families have received the Rs 10 lakh assistance
- **Gruha Lakshmi:** Rs 3 lakh grant each was to be given to 357,000 SC/ ST/ BC families to build homes



**"Keeping in mind fiscal prudence, we have enhanced the sops in a phased manner. Of all promises made in 2018, it's just the unemployment allowance that we couldn't fulfil"**

**–K. CHANDRASHEKAR RAO,** *Telangana CM*

ASSEMBLY POLLS 2023

TAKE FIVE

# RISING 'COST'

Cash, liquor, precious metals and other inducements—political parties have gone all out to 'buy' votes in **Telangana**

**₹130 CRORE**

Worth of seizures in just nine days after polls were announced on Nov. 30

**₹111 CRORE**

Worth of total seizures across two months of campaigning in 2018

**₹76 CRORE**

Worth of seizures ahead of the assembly election in 2014

# THE OTHERS

In **Rajasthan**, the Congress cornered 39.3% votes in 2018 and the BJP 38.8%, a difference of just **0.5** percentage points. But Independents got **9.5%**, BSP **4%**, other small parties **7.1%** and NOTA **1.3%**. Can the other players again tilt the results in favour of one of the two key contenders?